William Blair

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Aviation

Aerospace Industry Highlights: June Update

Our *Aerospace Industry Highlights* quarterly report contains our analysis of aftermarket, production/deliveries, orders, safety, travel, eVTOL, and M&A trends across the aerospace industry. Our equal-weighted index of aerospace aftermarket stocks increased 22% during the second quarter of 2026, compared with the S&P 500's 13% increase. We expect that aerospace aftermarket growth will remain healthy as airlines and business aviation operators continue to defer retirements.

- **U.S.-Iran conflict:** The U.S.-Iran conflict has continued to have a roller-coaster impact on aerospace shares. Our equal-weighted index of aerospace aftermarket stocks indicated an increase of 22% during the second quarter, whereas the S&P 500 increased 13%. Following the June 17 ceasefire agreement, oil prices declined significantly and many of the aerospace companies experienced big positive stock moves. As of today, the ceasefire agreement is stalled, which has put pressure on aerospace stocks once again.
- **Aftermarket trends:** During the peak periods of the U.S.-Iran conflict, aerospace aftermarket managers continued to emphasize that there was little to no impact from the conflict on their respective businesses. Despite the commentary, we believe there may be some slight softness in the second-quarter results relative to very strong 17% growth in the first quarter, but generally growth and profitability should remain healthy and the back half of the year should be strong.
- **Production/deliveries:** Boeing announced that production has officially started on the fourth line in Everett, Washington, for the B737 MAX. During the quarter, it was reported by *The Air Current* that Boeing was studying the potential of increasing B737 MAX production to as much as 70 aircraft per month, which would bring the company closer to Airbus's long-term narrowbody production rate target of roughly 75 A320 aircraft per month.
- **Orders:** Aircraft orders for both Boeing and Airbus were strong in the second quarter. For example, Lufthansa Group announced a 20 aircraft order in June for 10 B787s and 10 A350s.
- **Travel volumes:** Travel volumes declined 0.4% in the second quarter of 2026, from 1.5% growth in the first quarter. The U.S.-Iran conflict was the primary driver for the decline in travel volumes as higher oil prices led to an increase in airfare as well as some capacity reductions. Business jet travel in April increased 4% and then declined 32% in May. The May data is surprising given that CEO commentary on the state of the business aviation sector indicated that it was fairly resilient given the higher oil prices, but the decline may indicate otherwise. We would expect business travel trends to improve in June given oil prices declined following the ceasefire agreement.

AAR Corp.	
AIR (NYSE)	$135.15
Stock Rating:	**Outperform**
Arxis, Inc.	
ARXS (NASDAQ)	$41.64
Stock Rating:	**Outperform**
Curtiss-Wright Corporation	
CW (NYSE)	$750.35
Stock Rating:	**Outperform**
HEICO Corporation	
HEI (NYSE)	$353.97
Stock Rating:	**Outperform**
The Boeing Company	
BA (NYSE)	$218.60
Stock Rating:	**Outperform**
TransDigm Group Incorporated	
TDG (NYSE)	$1,227.73
Stock Rating:	**Outperform**
Vertical Aerospace Ltd.	
EVTL (NYSE)	$1.56
Stock Rating:	**Outperform**
VSE Corporation	
VSEC (NASDAQ)	$204.74
Stock Rating:	**Outperform**

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- **eVTOL:** The eVTOL industry continues to advance toward commercialization, with certification progress and regulatory and infrastructure development the primary focus. Vertical completed a two-way piloted transition flight under U.K. CAA oversight and secured $80 million of near-term funding as part of an up to $850 million financing package, significantly de-risking its certification pathway. Joby (JOBY $7.80) completed high-profile airport transfer demonstration flights in New York City, while BETA (BETA $18.48) continued expanding its electric aviation ecosystem through additional charging infrastructure deployments. The U.S. DOT and FAA selected eight projects across 26 states for the eVTOL Integration Pilot Program (eIPP) to accelerate real-world operations and regulatory readiness ahead of commercial service.

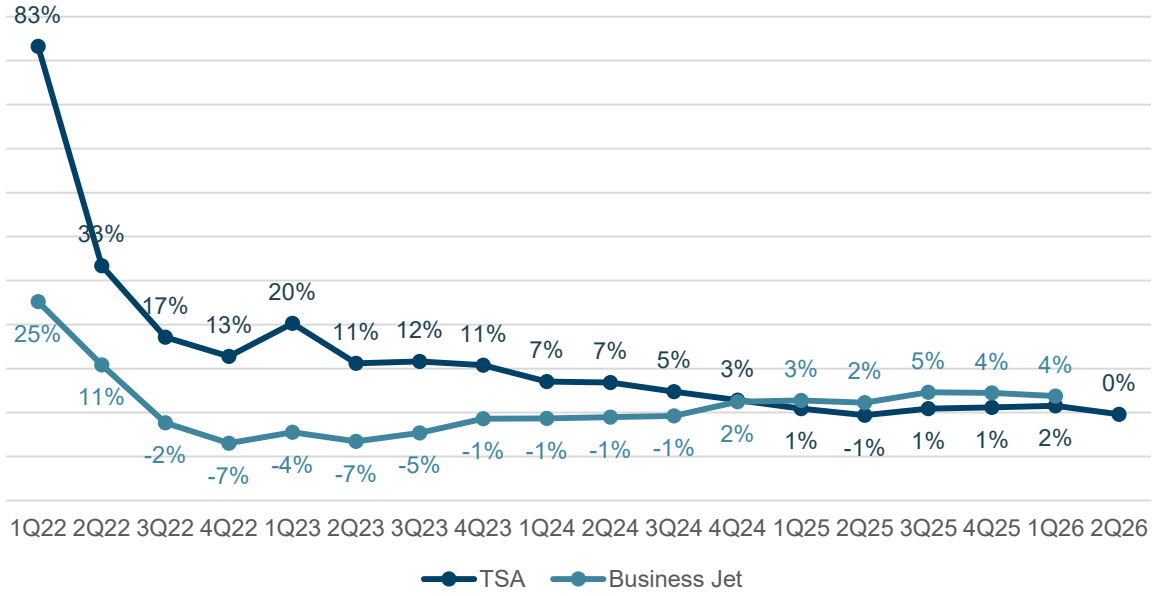
- **Safety/regulators:** In late June, the FAA proposed changes to speed up certification of new commercial aircraft, similar to the regulatory framework in Europe. During the same time, the FAA said that it is making significant progress on approving the B737 MAX 7 and MAX 10. Boeing expects these certifications to become official in 2026.

- **M&A:** Even with macro pressure impacting stock prices across the aerospace sector, M&A activity remained robust. Arxis and its private equity sponsor, Arcline Investment Management, made four acquisitions between June and early July. Arxis acquired Omnetics Connector and MagCanica for a total of $890 million, and Arcline acquired Continental Aerospace Technologies and Avantus Aerospace for a combined $1.6 billion. The other high-profile deals during the quarter included Blackstone and Tinicum's acquisition of Senior Plc for $1.9 billion and Parker Hannifin's (PH $952.39) acquisition of CIRCOR Commercial and Defense Aerospace business for $2.55 billion. On July 13, TransDigm announced that it was terminating its pending acquisition of Stellant Systems due to DOJ antitrust scrutiny.

- **Prior Quarterly Editions:**
  - March 2026: Aerospace Industry Highlights: March Update
  - December 2025: Aerospace Industry Highlights: December Update
  - September 2025: Aerospace Industry Highlights: September Update
  - June 2025: Second-Quarter Aerospace Industry Highlights

Exhibit 1

TSA Checkpoint Data and Business Jet Volume Growth



Source: TSA.gov, William Blair Equity Research

Exhibit 2

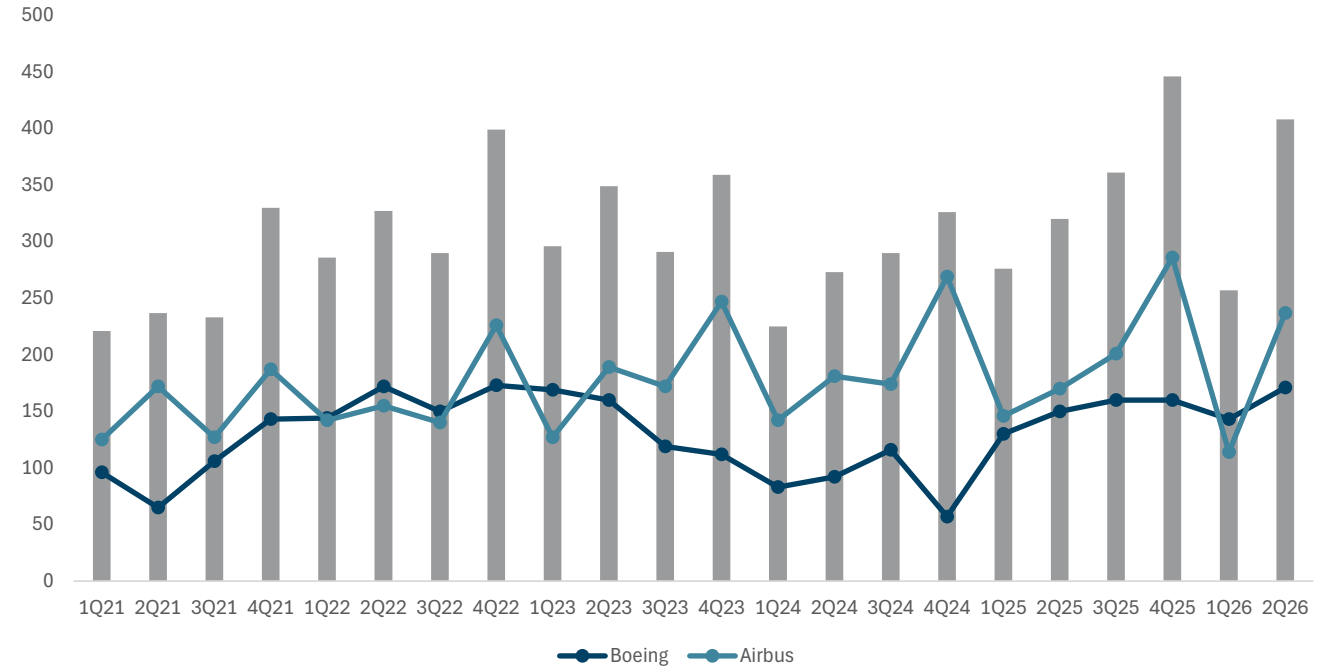
Aviation Aftermarket Product/Services Revenue by Service Provider (in Millions)

	1Q22	2Q22	3Q22	4Q22	1Q23	2Q23	3Q23	4Q23	1Q24	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26
GE Aerospace Services	$3,949	$4,370	$4,736	$5,152	$5,007	$5,327	$6,162	$5,955	$5,655	$6,047	$6,495	$6,650	$6,347	$7,308	$8,143	$8,365	$8,346
Boeing: Global Services	$4,314	$4,298	$4,432	$4,567	$4,720	$4,746	$4,812	$4,849	$5,045	$4,889	$4,901	$5,119	$4,758	$5,281	$5,370	$5,209	$5,370
Safran Aftermarket Services	$2,179	$2,462	$2,641	$2,969	$2,855	$2,994	$3,377	$3,481	$3,414	$3,757	$3,822	$3,931	$4,157	$4,322	$4,436	$4,702	$4,967
Pratt & Whitney Aftermarket	$2,204	$1,863	$2,212	$2,303	$2,504	$2,463	$2,677	$2,718	$2,729	$2,833	$3,025	$3,180	$3,493	$3,371	$3,720	$3,848	$4,157
Collins Aerospace Aftermarket	$1,502	$1,547	$1,608	$1,705	$1,841	$1,970	$2,088	$2,097	$2,099	$2,207	$2,276	$2,349	$2,372	$2,493	$2,572	$2,654	$2,538
Lufthansa Technik	$1,445	$1,379	$1,550	$1,675	$1,675	$1,734	$1,838	$1,889	$1,929	$2,043	$2,002	$2,136	$2,201	$2,132	$2,117	$2,324	$2,458
Honeywell Commercial Aviation Aftermarket	$1,168	$1,208	$1,339	$1,393	$1,423	$1,533	$1,634	$1,651	$1,659	$1,798	$1,758	$1,929	$1,899	$1,916	$2,085	$1,877	$1,959
StandardAero					$1,149	$1,157	$1,099	$1,158	$1,236	$1,347	$1,245	$1,410	$1,436	$1,529	$1,498	$1,600	$1,627
Airbus Services	$723	$666	$795	$923	$959	$1,194	$1,095	$1,352	$1,284	$1,293	$1,294	$1,587	$1,555	$1,449	$1,378	$1,558	$1,560
MTU Aero Engines	$893	$892	$937	$975	$1,113	$1,055	$1,024	$1,125	$1,244	$1,156	$1,284	$1,623	$1,658	$1,393	$1,637	$1,808	$1,788
Airbus Helicopter Services	$672	$704	$825	$817	$815	$880	$876	$998	$867	$924	$934	$1,086	$966	$952	$956	$1,167	$976
GD Aircraft Services	$641	$755	$635	$660	$741	$737	$684	$749	$823	$873	$796	$946	$858	$933	$941	$965	$968
Transdigm Commercial After-market	$386	$420	$452	$480	$544	$579	$594	$620	$626	$638	$576	$674	$693	$695	$742	$728	$839
Heico: Flight Support Group	$306	$330	$346	$371	$392	$405	$602	$619	$647	$682	$692	$713	$767	$803	$834	$820	$929
AAR Corp Aviation Services	$438	$453	$424	$446	$499	$530	$550	$530	$549	$640	$636	$666	$650	$728	$717	$774	$826
Textron Aviation Aftermarket Parts & Services	$394	$428	$434	$430	$431	$442	$447	$476	$456	$500	$470	$484	$483	$507	$492	$551	$531
Bombardier Services	$361	$359	$372	$416	$424	$428	$414	$482	$477	$507	$528	$524	$495	$590	$590	$630	$617
Parker Hannifin Commercial Aftermarket	$128	$145	$205	$352	$382	$426	$391	$438	$482	$503	$521	$531	$568	$594	$594	$619	$647
Embraer Services & Support	$271	$320	$295	$381	$326	$340	$366	$386	$366	$404	$426	$441	$425	$456	$493	$552	$490
Eaton Aerospace Aftermarket	$221	$242	$256	$258	$264	$297	$302	$320	$291	$329	$341	$351	$350	$396	$404	$403	$446
FTAI Aviation: Aerospace Products	$14	$26	$53	$84	$85	$93	$119	$158	$189	$245	$303	$342	$365	$490	$518	$563	$744
Delta Tech Ops (MRO)													$151				$380
VSE Corp	$93	$105	$103	$107	$113	$125	$152	$154	$162	$193	$204	$227	$256	$272	$283	$301	$325
Woodward Commercial Services	$109	$109	$118	$127	$139	$140	$142	$138	$164	$166	$174	$164	$202	$215	$242	$245	$275
Aersale (ex. Leasing)	$115	$132	$43	$90	$73	$66	$90	$91	$87	$73	$76	$87	$58	$99	$62	$81	$59
Moog Commercial Aftermarket				$52	$53	$60	$69	$65	$67	$57	$75	$77	$80	$86	$88	$98	$83
Crane Commercial Aftermarket	$29	$29	$35	$37	$38	$41	$49	$53	$51	$52	$54	$61	$60	$57	$67	$63	$53
Loar Group Aftermarket					$29	$27	$32	$31	$35	$37	$39	$38	$44	$47	$51	$52	$55
Total	**$22,589**	**$23,283**	**$24,891**	**$26,813**	**$28,640**	**$29,835**	**$31,743**	**$32,659**	**$32,720**	**$34,278**	**$35,039**	**$37,326**	**$37,653**	**$39,114**	**$41,031**	**$42,557**	**$44,010**
Y/Y Growth	*28%*	*26%*	*23%*	*7%*	*21%*	*23%*	*23%*	*17%*	*14%*	*15%*	*11%*	*15%*	*15%*	*14%*	*17%*	*14%*	*17%*

Source: Company Reports, William Blair Equity Research

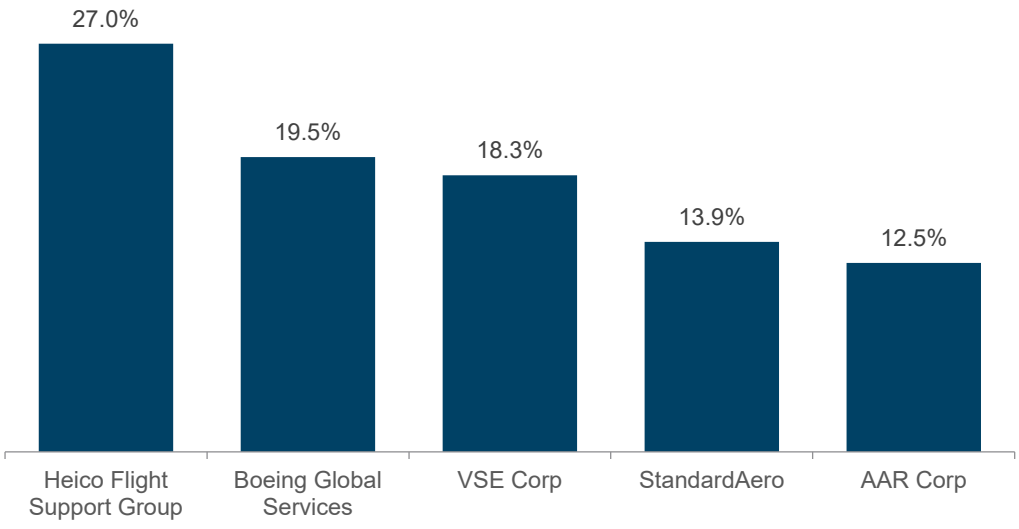
* Includes contributions from M&A

Exhibit 3
Commercial Delivery Trends (Boeing and Airbus)



Sources: Company Reports, William Blair Equity Research

Exhibit 4
EBITDA Margins of Key Aftermarket Providers (NTM)



Sources: William Blair Equity Research, Company Reports

Exhibit 5
Aerospace Industry
Consensus Valuation Comp Table

Stock Data					Valuation				Growth		Margin	
				Mkt Cap	EV/EBITDA		P/E		Sales Growth		EBITDA Margin	
Company Name	Ticker	Rating	Price	($m)	+1	+2	+1	+2	+1	+2	+1	+2
Aerospace OEMs												
Airbus SE Unsponsored ADR	EADSY	NC	$55.97	$176,559.3	14.2x	12.4x	26.8x	22.7x	7%	11%	13%	14%
Boeing Company	BA	OP	$219.13	$172,674.4	45.1x	23.1x	NM	53.2x	9%	15%	5%	8%
General Dynamics Corporation	GD	MP	$367.86	$100,841.1	15.7x	14.6x	NM	20.1x	5%	5%	12%	13%
Textron Inc.	TXT	NC	$88.53	$15,596.9	9.4x	9.2x	13.6x	12.1x	5%	3%	12%	12%
					15.0x	**13.5x**	**20.2x**	**21.4x**	**6%**	**8%**	**12%**	**12%**
Commercial Aerospace Suppliers												
AAR CORP.	AIR	OP	$134.61	$5,317.2	15.5x	13.6x	27.4x	24.1x	18%	11%	12%	13%
Arxis, Inc. Class A	ARXS	OP	$41.74	$17,127.4	26.8x	23.7x	118.4x	58.8x	18%	10%	39%	40%
Astronics Corporation	ATRO	NC	$70.13	$2,680.6	17.5x	14.8x	28.0x	23.6x	14%	9%	18%	19%
Curtiss-Wright Corporation	CW	OP	$749.44	$27,772.6	33.7x	30.5x	49.2x	43.8x	8%	8%	22%	23%
Eaton Corp. Plc	ETN	NC	$410.42	$159,733.5	23.8x	20.3x	30.8x	26.1x	17%	11%	24%	25%
FTAI Aviation Ltd.	FTAI	NC	$210.29	$21,923.5	16.9x	11.3x	30.3x	16.8x	43%	54%	41%	40%
HEICO Corporation	HEI	OP	$351.66	$49,608.0	35.1x	31.8x	57.7x	51.1x	18%	10%	28%	28%
Hexcel Corporation	HXL	NC	$102.13	$7,833.4	21.9x	18.5x	44.5x	33.2x	10%	10%	19%	21%
Honeywell Aerospace Inc	HONA	NC	$215.11	$68,163.0	16.8x	15.4x	23.9x	21.3x		8%	26%	26%
Howmet Aerospace Inc.	HWM	NC	$275.66	$111,091.0	36.4x	31.4x	54.4x	45.5x	18%	13%	32%	33%
Loar Holdings Inc.	LOAR	NC	$70.01	$6,696.5	28.8x	25.6x	55.9x	46.4x	27%	11%	41%	42%
RTX Corporation	RTX	NC	$195.39	$266,629.2	19.6x	18.0x	28.1x	25.6x	6%	7%	16%	16%
StandardAero, Inc.	SARO	NC	$27.43	$9,144.1	12.8x	11.2x	21.2x	17.2x	6%	10%	14%	14%
TransDigm Group Incorporated	TDG	OP	$1,223.21	$71,190.5	18.4x	16.7x	30.6x	26.0x	18%	9%	52%	53%
VSE Corporation	VSEC	OP	$205.31	$5,714.7	15.0x	11.7x	47.0x	35.5x	60%	22%	18%	19%
Woodward, Inc.	WWD	NC	$401.32	$24,591.3	27.9x	24.7x	42.7x	37.3x	21%	9%	21%	22%
					20.7x	**18.3x**	**36.7x**	**29.7x**	**18%**	**10%**	**23%**	**24%**
Commercial Airlines												
Alaska Air Group, Inc.	ALK	NC	$47.91	$5,475.8	9.6x	4.6x	506.6x	7.3x	11%	6%	7%	13%
American Airlines Group Inc.	AAL	NC	$15.65	$10,347.5	9.8x	6.4x	NM	6.0x	15%	4%	6%	9%
Delta Air Lines, Inc.	DAL	NC	$85.85	$56,489.3	7.7x	6.4x	NM	9.7x	14%	4%	14%	16%
JetBlue Airways Corporation	JBLU	NC	$5.57	$2,065.4	31.8x	9.7x	NM	NM	13%	7%	3%	9%
Southwest Airlines Co.	LUV	NC	$49.10	$24,697.3	7.8x	5.9x	NM	10.1x	17%	4%	11%	14%
United Airlines Holdings, Inc.	UAL	NC	$120.73	$39,454.6	7.0x	5.5x	11.5x	8.0x	14%	5%	12%	14%
					8.7x	**6.2x**	**259.1x**	**8.0x**	**14%**	**4%**	**9%**	**14%**
eVTOLs												
Archer Aviation Inc Class A	ACHR	NC	$4.80	$3,677.0	NM	NM	NM	NM	3054%	735%	NM	NM
BETA Technologies, Inc. Class A	BETA	NC	$18.44	$4,234.6	NM	NM	NM	NM	17%	703%	NM	NM
Eve Holding, Inc.	EVEX	NC	$2.36	$828.5	NM	NM	NM	NM			NM	NM
Joby Aviation, Inc.	JOBY	NC	$7.76	$7,325.0	NM	NM	NM	NM	119%	98%	NM	NM
Vertical Aerospace Ltd.	EVTL	OP	$1.61	$228.7	NM	NM	NM	NM			NM	NM
									119%	**703%**		

Note: OP=Outperform, MP=Market Perform, UP= Underperform, NC = Not covered, NM= Not Material
Source: FactSet

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Underperform (Sell)	1	Underperform (Sell)	0

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